

of credit should go to the Supreme Court, which, to prevent the Taj from decaying, has prohibited construction around the monument.

K. PRADEEP, *Chennai*

Sporting Glory

Every state should take a cue from Gujarat on how to nurture their sportspersons ("The Rule of Iron", July 16). The story brings a ray of hope that India will one day produce world class athletes.

SIDDHARTH GARG, *Delhi*

Media-centric

Rakhi Sawant's candid confession that media is her godfather is really praiseworthy ("Seedhi Baat", July 16). She is, in fact, the creation of media hype only.

GAUTAM BHUYAN, *Bangalore*

Negative Energy

For energy security in the country, the Government should first ban sale of new cars, especially in metros ("High Octane Crisis", July 16). It is important not only for energy security, but also for controlling pollution in big cities, which in some-way, is contributing to erratic weather changes.

RAHUL GARG, *Delhi*

Historical Secrets

Suddenly publishers in India have taken it upon themselves to brush up the nation's sense of history ("An Enchanted Past", July 16). If Nehru and Edwina Mountbatten got along famously, Gandhi, too, had his share of controversies. With each new release promising to unsheathe some of the guarded secrets of pre-Independence

India, walking down the trails of the past has never been so exciting.

ALAP MOHAN, *Bangalore*

Valley of Death

The growing number of suicides in Kashmir is a cause of concern for the state Government ("Extremism of Another Kind", July 9). It should try and identify problems that are driving the youth towards suicide. Also, non-government organisations should take steps to intro-

duce classes for those suffering from depression.

PRARTHANA ACHARYYA,

Guwahati

An Eye Opener

The story on useless ministries is thought provoking ("White Elephants", June 18). It is disheartening to know that the creation of a plethora of departments has killed accountability. Language is bold, it depicts the flaws of the Government.

V.R. VENKATAKRISHNAN, *Cochin*

DEVIL AND DEEP SEA



Bhairon Singh Shekhawat has his own reasons for fighting the Presidential Poll ("Why is he Fighting", July 16). Apart from BJP, he enjoys tacit support of many MPs and MLAs. At 83, even if he loses the election, his spirit is going to win.

VIRENDRA KUMAR TANGRI, *Dehradun*

I understand the hoopla against Pratibha Patil becoming the next President. But her opponent is equally unworthy of the coveted post. What are the credentials of Shekhawat apart from being an old warhorse in politics?

ALPANA DAS, *Delhi*

It's sad that Shekhawat has been pitted against Patil who is a stubborn loyalist of the Gandhi family. Politics played over the post of the President will be marked as one of the darkest chapters of Indian politics.

PARANJYOTI DUTTA, *Teok, Assam*

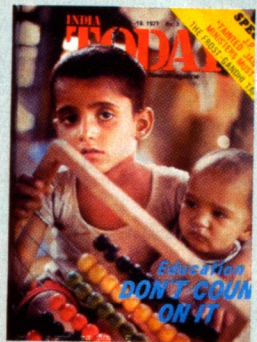
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Years Ago in India Today

AUGUST 1-15, 1977



Sex and the City

India's first Workshop on Human Sexuality was a pioneering effort in the hazy world of human reproduction and its long-term implications. The final report on the Workshop, held in February this year, is just being okayed for the press. It wades through the labyrinth of Indian sexual traditions and mores as seen through the eyes of 45 hand-



Dr Rosales

picked professors, psychologists, doctors and a sexologist, social scientists, counsellors and a nurse. It was Dr Vicente Rosales of the University of Santo Tomas, Manila, who gave an exposition of adult sexual instinct; he termed it the "search for a stable, lasting emotional relationship with a partner of the opposite sex". There were several lectures which spanned the whole gamut of sexuality. What is overwhelming is the fact that in a country like India, such a Pandora's box has been opened.

—Ashok Row Kavi